

THE CRAFT ROOM

CROCHET MADE SIMPLE

The Complete Beginner's Starter Kit

A Step-by-Step Guide • 5 Easy Patterns • Printable Cheat Sheets



**LEARN THE BASICS.
MAKE YOUR FIRST FIVE PROJECTS.**



CHAIN • each loop is one chain stitch

No complicated jargon. No giant supply list. Just the skills you need to start crocheting with confidence.

01 • START HERE

WELCOME

If you've never picked up a crochet hook before, this guide gets you from zero to five finished projects — no confusing jargon, no wasted money on the wrong supplies. Crochet is one loop pulled through another loop, repeated. Everything else is just vocabulary and practice.

INSIDE THIS KIT

- Plain-English tools, stitches, and pattern reading
- Troubleshooting for common beginner frustrations
- 5 complete beginner patterns
- 2 printable reference sheets

WHAT YOU ACTUALLY NEED

Hook: H/8 (5mm) aluminum hook

Yarn: Worsted weight, labeled "4"

Extras: Scissors + yarn needle

Tip: Skip 12-hook starter kits until you know which sizes you use.

THE 5 STITCHES YOU NEED FIRST

1 CHAIN (ch)

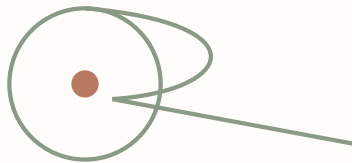
The foundation row nearly every project starts from.



CHAIN • each loop is one chain stitch

2 SLIP STITCH (sl st)

Joins pieces or moves your position without adding height.



SLIP KNOT • pull gently to tighten

3 SINGLE CROCHET (sc)

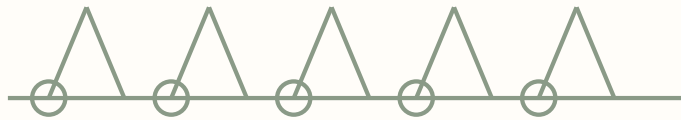
Dense and sturdy; great for coasters and amigurumi.



SINGLE CROCHET • insert, yarn over, pull through

4 HALF DOUBLE CROCHET (hdc)

A medium-height stitch, quick to work.



HALF DOUBLE CROCHET • yarn over before inserting

5 DOUBLE CROCHET (dc)

Taller and drapier; common in blankets and garments.



DOUBLE CROCHET • taller stitch with extra yarn over

Beginner focus: Master single crochet and double crochet first — together they appear in the majority of beginner patterns.

02 • READ A PATTERN

Patterns are written in shorthand. Here's the core vocabulary:

ch	chain	inc	increase
sl st	slip stitch	dec	decrease
sc	single crochet	sc2tog	single crochet 2 together
hdc	half double crochet	BLO	back loop only
dc	double crochet	rnd(s)	round(s)
yo	yarn over	st(s)	stitch(es)
MC	magic circle/ring	rep	repeat

TRY IT VISUALLY



COUNT • mark or count every stitch

Example: “Rnd 3: (sc, inc) around. (18 sts)” means alternate one single crochet with one increase all the way around, ending with 18 stitches total. The number in parentheses is a stitch-count check.

FIXING THE 3 MOST COMMON BEGINNER PROBLEMS

“My crochet is curling.”

Usually caused by tight tension or an all-single-crochet fabric. Try a hook one size larger, and loosen your grip on the yarn.

“My edges are uneven.”

Almost always a miscounted last stitch in the row. Count your stitches at the end of every row until it becomes automatic.

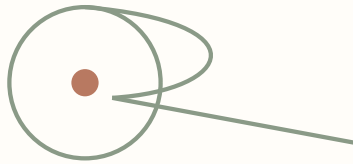
“My stitch count doesn't match the pattern.”

Check you're inserting the hook under both loops of each stitch (unless the pattern says BLO or FLO), and double-check you haven't skipped the first or last stitch in the row.

03 • YOUR FIRST SKILLS

Before the patterns, practice these movements until your hands feel comfortable.

SLIP KNOT



SLIP KNOT • pull gently to tighten

Make the loop, pull the working yarn through, then tighten gently around the hook. The loop should move freely.

CHAIN STITCH



CHAIN • each loop is one chain stitch

A chain creates the foundation for many projects. Keep the tension relaxed so your chain does not become stiff.

SINGLE CROCHET



SINGLE CROCHET • insert, yarn over, pull through

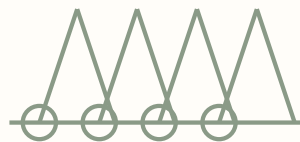
The guide uses single crochet in several beginner projects. Practice inserting your hook consistently and counting each stitch.

HALF DOUBLE + DOUBLE CROCHET



HALF DOUBLE CROCHET • yarn over before inserting

Half double crochet is a medium-height stitch and works up quickly.

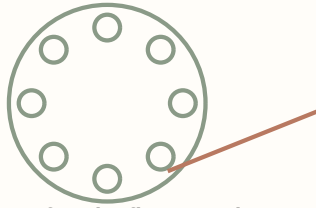


DOUBLE CROCHET • taller stitch with extra yarn over

Double crochet is taller and drapier and is common in blankets and garments.

04 • BUILD YOUR FIRST PROJECTS

MAGIC RING + WORKING IN ROUNDS



MAGIC RING • tighten the center after the first round

A magic circle/ring creates an adjustable center for round projects such as flowers, daisies, granny squares, and coasters.

COUNTING + INCREASING



COUNT • mark or count every stitch

Count the stitches at the end of every row until it becomes automatic.



INCREASE • work 2 stitches into the same stitch

An increase means working 2 stitches into the same stitch.

PATTERN 1 • SIMPLE BEGINNER DISHCLOTH

Skill: Absolute beginner **Materials:** Worsted weight cotton yarn, 5mm (H/8) hook

Finished size: Approx. 7" × 7"

1. Chain 20.
2. Row 1: Single crochet in the 2nd chain from hook and in each chain across (19 sc).
3. Chain 1, turn.
4. Row 2 onward: Single crochet in each stitch across. Chain 1, turn.
5. Repeat Row 2 until the piece measures approximately 7 inches.
6. Fasten off and weave in ends.

PATTERN 2 • FIVE-PETAL PUFF FLOWER

Skill: Beginner **Materials:** Small amount of worsted yarn, 5mm hook

Finished size: Approx. 2.5" diameter

1. Make a magic ring (or chain 4 and join with a slip stitch to form a ring).
2. Round 1: Chain 1, work 10 single crochet into the ring. Join with a slip stitch. (10 sts)
3. Round 2 (petals): *Chain 3, skip 1 stitch, slip stitch into the next stitch; repeat from * around (5 petal loops).
4. For each petal loop: work (sl st, hdc, 2 dc, hdc, sl st) into the chain-3 space.
5. Fasten off, leaving a tail for sewing the flower onto a project.

05 • FIVE EASY PATTERNS

Keep your stitch count visible as you work. That's one of the fastest ways to build confidence.

PATTERN 3 • SIMPLE DAISY

Skill: Beginner **Materials:** Yarn in two colors, 5mm hook

Finished size: Approx. 3" diameter

1. With color A (center), make a magic ring.
2. Round 1: Chain 1, work 8 single crochet into the ring. Join with a slip stitch. Fasten off.
3. Join color B in any stitch of Round 1.
4. Round 2 (petals): *Chain 4, slip stitch back into the same stitch to form a petal, slip stitch into the next stitch; repeat from * around (8 petals).
5. Fasten off and weave in ends.

PATTERN 4 • CLASSIC GRANNY SQUARE

Skill: Beginner to advancing **Materials:** Yarn in up to 3 colors, 5mm hook

Finished size: Approx. 5" × 5" (2 rounds)

1. Make a magic ring. Chain 3 (counts as first dc), work 2 dc into the ring, chain 2, then repeat (3 dc, chain 2) three more times into the ring. Join with a slip stitch to the top of the starting chain-3. (4 corner groups)
2. Round 2: Slip stitch into the next chain-2 space. Chain 3, (2 dc, chain 2, 3 dc) into the same space — this is one corner. Chain 1. *Into the next chain-2 space: (3 dc, chain 2, 3 dc); chain 1; repeat from * around. Join with a slip stitch.
3. Continue adding rounds in the same pattern for a larger square, changing colors between rounds if desired.
4. Fasten off and weave in ends.

PATTERN 5 • TEXTURED COASTER

Skill: Beginner, slightly advancing **Materials:** Worsted cotton yarn, 5mm hook

Finished size: Approx. 4" diameter

1. Make a magic ring. Round 1: Chain 1, work 6 single crochet into the ring. Join with a slip stitch. (6 sts)
2. Round 2: Chain 1, 2 sc in each stitch around. Join. (12 sts)
3. Round 3: Chain 1, *sc in next st, 2 sc in next st; repeat from * around. Join. (18 sts)
4. Round 4: Chain 1, *sc in next 2 sts, 2 sc in next st; repeat from * around. Join. (24 sts)
5. Fasten off, leaving a tail. Weave in ends. Block flat if it cups slightly — this is normal for single crochet worked in the round.

06 • PRINTABLE REFERENCE

ABBREVIATIONS CHEAT SHEET

Print this page and keep it beside your crochet bag for quick reference.

Abbreviation	Meaning
ch	chain
sl st	slip stitch
sc	single crochet
hdc	half double crochet
dc	double crochet
tr	treble crochet
yo	yarn over
st(s)	stitch(es)
sp	space
rep	repeat
inc	increase
dec	decrease
sc2tog	single crochet 2 together
BLO / FLO	back loop only / front loop only
rnd(s)	round(s)
MC	magic circle / magic ring
RS / WS	right side / wrong side

QUICK REMINDER

ch = chain • sl st = slip stitch • sc = single crochet • hdc = half double crochet • dc = double crochet

07 • HOOK SIZE GUIDE

HOOK SIZE CONVERSION CHART

Print this page and keep it with your hook set.

US Size	Metric	Common Use
B/1	2.25mm	Thread crochet, fine lace
D/3	3.25mm	Lightweight yarn, doilies
E/4	3.5mm	Amigurumi, light garments
F/5	3.75mm	Baby items
G/6	4mm	DK weight yarn
H/8	5mm	Worsted weight — most common
I/9	5.5mm	Worsted to bulky
J/10	6mm	Bulky, chunky projects
N/15	10mm	Extra bulky, quick projects



WORKING IN ROUNDS • keep your joins consistent

YOU'RE READY TO START

Thank you for downloading Crochet Made Simple! Tag your finished projects — we'd love to see what you make.

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